

Matthew Beardwell

Watford, Hertfordshire · contact@mbeardwell.com · mbeardwell.com

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · [TryHackMe](#)

Professional Summary

Digital forensics and OSINT practitioner with experience in client investigations, toolkit development, and threat intelligence analysis. Experience includes ARM instruction patching and binary analysis. Recovered deleted data and artefacts in both lab-based and real-world contexts. Completed 127 hands-on labs (~103 hrs est., Top 2% TryHackMe) and earned a First-Class BSc in Computer Science from King's College London. Currently preparing for CompTIA Security+.

Technical Skills

- **Scripting and Programming:** Python, Bash, C, ARM Assembly
- **Networking:** Wireshark, TCP/IP analysis, PCAP inspection
- **Forensics:** Autopsy, dd, foremost, photorec, scalpel; disk image recovery and file carving
- **OSINT:** Identity/location tracing, metadata correlation, client investigations, toolkit authoring
- **Reverse Engineering:** GDB, IDA Free, Ghidra, radare2, ARM runtime patching
- **SOC & Defensive (lab exposure):** Splunk, SIEM fundamentals, log analysis, alert triage, Active Directory, phishing analysis, Volatility (memory forensics), IDS/IPS concepts

Cybersecurity Projects

ActiveReconLite · Python Port Scanner

FEB 2025 – MAR 2025

Built a Python-based TCP connect port scanner using multiprocessing. Validates user input, grabs banners, and writes results to a file. Demonstrates socket programming, argparse, regex, and parallel scanning.

github.com/mbeardwell/active-recon-lite

Location and Identity Resolution from Minimal Public Signals · OSINT Case Study

APR 2025

Tracked real-world identity from anonymised YouTube uploads using public data. Shows attacker thinking, threat profiling, and privacy risk awareness. Demonstrates threat intelligence process fundamentals: collection, enrichment, analysis, and attribution based on minimal public indicators.

github.com/mbeardwell/osint-i3-case-study

UK Person-centric OSINT Toolkit

JUN 2025

Curation of UK-only, legal person-focused OSINT resources for investigative use. Featured by “Learn Cybersecurity” Telegram channel (27k subscribers); 100+ LinkedIn/Substack clicks in 1 week.

github.com/mbeardwell/uk-personal-osint-toolkit

Faster Dynamically Instrumented Programs · Bachelor's Thesis

OCT 2022 – MAY 2023

Developed PoC mimicking evasive malware behaviour by changing programs in memory at the lowest level.

github.com/mbeardwell/arm-fp-emu

Professional Experience

OSINT Investigator · Freelance & Self-Led

MAY 2023 – APR 2025

Conducted person-tracing investigations for clients, delivering structured confidential reports with confidence-weighted findings across identity, contact, residential, and family data. Also independently executed geolocation and identity resolution projects documented in a published case study.

Maths Tutor · Freelance

SEP 2016 – NOV 2019

Tutored students aged 9–13 in maths (11+ and GCSE prep).

Education and Certifications

Security Training · TryHackMe

FEB 2022 – PRESENT

Completed 127 hands-on labs (~103 hrs est.) across SOC operations, alert triage, SIEM/Splunk, log analysis, DFIR, memory forensics, Active Directory, phishing analysis, IDS/IPS, malware analysis, digital forensics, OSINT, and reverse engineering. Ranked in the Top 2% globally.

BSc (Hons) CS · King's College London

First-Class

SEP 2018 – AUG 2023

A-Levels · King's Maths School

A* A* A* A*

SEP 2016 – AUG 2018

CompTIA

Security+

(IN PROGRESS)

TryHackMe

Intro to Cyber Security

FEB 2024

Security Blue Team

Intro to OSINT

JUN 2025

TryHackMe

Pre-Security

APR 2022

Prince's Trust

TEAM (12-week programme incl. First Aid)

JAN 2024 – APR 2024

Updated: 27/02/2026